THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION, PARIS BRANCH

NEWSLETTER – January 2017

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Chairman's Report

After some 18 years of energetic commitment to The Royal British Legion Paris Branch, Roger Thorn stood down as our Chairman at the Branch's AGM held at the Clubhouse 28 November 2016. I was elected to take over from Roger, having been your Vice-Chairman for a number of years.

I open this newsletter by thanking all those who stood for and were elected to the Committee. I am very pleased to know that I have the continuing support of the Officers on the Standing Committee, Janet Warby and Ian McDonald, as well as that of other members of the Committee. The limitations of space don't allow me the opportunity to name everyone so I have attached a list of their names together with a note of their main area of activity and responsibility. I am truly sad that after many years of loyal service to the Legion, Jim Cockle has decided to stand down. I appreciate his reasons for doing so: he will be sorely missed!

Your Committee perceives the beginning of a new year as an appropriate opportunity not only to continue with the projects and activities that have already been launched, but also to "kick-start" other initiatives that have been discussed. You will recall that in my election address I mentioned the need for us to engage actively in organic growth in both membership and activities. We have to focus on those structures we already have in place, and to evaluate how we can improve, enlarge and enhance them. We are always actively seeking new members and also assessing how we can develop our activities. Your help in these areas would be greatly appreciated!

My priority is to establish effective communication with each of our members, and with prospective members. Mark Yates, together with Caroline Clopet, will be looking at this area, concentrating especially on developing our website and our Facebook page. In this respect we are aware that some people do not have Internet access so you will find attached a list of the winners of the Christmas Tombola draw that took place at our very successful Christmas lunch for which I must thank Tony Bennett, our stalwart chef who can always be relied upon to serve us superb meals! Also included with this newsletter is a list of some of this year's events. Please take the time to add these to your agenda so as to ensure you do not miss out on them.

Our January lunch (attended by 31 members!) was followed by a most interesting, enlightening and enjoyable presentation, by Colonel Geoffrey Cardozo on the Foundation Franco-Britannique de Sillery,

My hope is that we shall be able to tempt you with more "extras" similar to this on future occasions.
Your Committee's intention is to be able to offer members the choice of attending at least two significant events per month, apart from July and August. If you are interested, I would advise your making an early booking.

With this in mind, on 21 February we will be holding a Branch General Meeting in our Clubhouse. This meeting is open to all members, and I hope that many of you will come. This will be an opportunity to hear from the Committee and to learn about what the Paris Branch is doing now. You will also hear about our plans for the future and, of course, you'll be given every opportunity to ask us questions! By mid-February Janet Warby, our Secretary, will be sending you more details of this event. We will also be holding a Farewell Dinner for Roger Thorn on 24 February, the details of which will be sent out before the end of January.
In March, in addition to our monthly lunch, we are planning a Wine Tasting evening that will also include a small supper. Details of which will be sent out to you nearer the time. Our Events Manager, Ed Plunkett, plans all these activities in order to ensure our members have more than just a monthly lunch and the Legion magazine to look forward to!

I also wish that we establish and maintain firmer links with our elderly members who find the Clubhouse too far for them to travel. I am working on how to develop this idea.
Should you have any comments, ideas or suggestions regarding the Royal British Legion, Paris Branch, please feel free to contact me. I would welcome hearing from you.

David Bean
Chairman